

» CARBONATES

TWINNED
ARAGONITE CRYSTALSFLOS FERRI
("FLOWERS OF IRON")
ARAGONITE**ARAGONITE**Orthorhombic
H $3\frac{1}{2}$ –4 • SG 2.95

Aragonite is a calcium carbonate, chemically identical to calcite, but in a different crystal system and much less common.



BOTRYOIDAL SIDERITE

SIDERITETrigonal
H $3\frac{1}{2}$ –4½ • SG 3.96A brown-coloured carbonate of iron, named from the Greek for iron, *sideros*, siderite occurs in a variety of forms.RHOMBOHEDRAL
SIDERITEshort
prismatic
crystals**PHOSGENITE**

Tetragonal • H 2–3 • SG 6.12–6.15

This rare lead carbonate chloride is formed close to Earth's surface by the reaction of lead-rich minerals with water.

**ARTINITE**Monoclinic • H $2\frac{1}{2}$ • SG 2.01–2.03

A hydrated magnesium carbonate hydroxide, artinite has a distinctive habit, with sprays of white, needle-shaped crystals. It occurs in serpentine rocks.

patch of green
malachite
around margins

limonite matrix

AZURITEMonoclinic • H $3\frac{1}{2}$ –4 • SG 3.77

Azurite is a hydrous copper carbonate. Its rich blue colour and frequent association with green malachite in hydrothermal veins are distinctive features.

**LEADHILLITE**Monoclinic • H $2\frac{1}{2}$ –3 • SG 6.55

This lead sulfate carbonate hydroxide usually occurs as well-formed crystals in the oxidized zones of lead deposits.

botryoidal
habit